

a dig with

BOB INGRAM

Rapp now can't rap 'the bigs'



RAPP

THE WEEK'S DOUBLE jackpot goes to Vern Rapp . . . He managed in the Texas League and other minors for years with distinction, yet didn't get that call from "The Bigs." . . . After managing Denver to the American Assn. championship this year, he was ready to quit and get into a more rewarding business . . . Then he two offers . . . One to manage the S.F. Giants and the other to manage the St. Louis Cardinals . . . didn't take him long to pick the Cards . . . Vern was one of my favorite managers . . . While covering the Sun Kings at Dudley Field, I spent a lot of time in his dugout when he was managing Arkansas. Incidentally, Rapp was a catcher for Denver when Andy Cohen managed that club . . . "Non-Look List" of Sun Bowl: Kansas State, Virginia, Tampa Bay Buccaneers, Earl Butz, the walking catfish . . . What they're doing now: Arizona State's Kirk Carter (tight end) and Glenn Crawford (defensive back) both of El Paso, have had knee surgery . . . Carter's college career is over. Crawford had one more season of eligibility . . . Who is the father of a UTEP football player who calls the Dallas UPI office late each Saturday night to get the Miner scores . . . Miner players Victor Moore, Don Rogers and Bobby Duncan are from Dallas . . . Did you hear about the school that had so many rich football players that the coach had unlisted playing numbers?

Tide closer

IS THIS THE year the Sun Bowl lands Alabama and Bear Bryant? A couple more defeats for the Tide and the Sun might have a chance to grab the team away from the bigger bowls . . . The Bear would be a big attraction here whether he can walk on the Rio Grande or not . . . Footballosophy of Bud Grant, Minnesota coach: "I can't afford the luxury of emotion on the sideline." . . . And Henry Frnka who bought his Tulsa University team to the Sun Bowl in 1942 and visited his friend and former player Bobby Dobbs in El Paso recently believes that a team fumbling the ball to its opponent should be penalized 15 yards instead of giving up the ball . . . Etta Lynch of Canyon has written a book about Texas Tech's famed coach, Pete Cawthon . . . It's called "Tender Tyrant, the Legend of Pete Cawthon." . . . At Utah last week, I saw my first tailgate party . . . It was in the parking lot of the Utah stadium just before the Utes played the Miners . . . The picnickers were gathered around campers and other vehicles and were having a good time despite threatening clouds . . . Spec Gammon, sports information director of Texas A&M, tells about a more sophisticated parking lot picnic at Illinois just before the Illini played the Aggies last Saturday . . . The participants were having a catered dinner with gold and silver plates . . . They ate lobster flown in from the East and were served by waiters in tuxedos.